

SOCIALIZATION

Meaning of Socialization

Socialization is a process interacts with others and shape as well as mold his/her personality according to the prescribed norms of a society.

Definitions of Socialization

Following are the some important definitions of socialization by renowned sociologists.

1. **Macionis** "The life long process through which an individual becomes the proper member of society and develops human characteristics."
2. **Horton and Hunt** "It is a learning process in which groups interact and learn social norms to develop his/her self."
3. **According to Ogburn:** "It is the process of learning the norms of the group and society".
4. **Maciver:** "It is the process through which social beings learns how to develop relationships and association with others."
5. **Bogardus:** "A process of learning to live and work together is called socialization."

The newborn child cannot become social being unless there is interaction with other human beings.

Helpless at birth, the human infant depends on others to provide nourishment and care. Human infants are the most helpless of all. It is a matter of survival of human child, that's why to transform the human child into a social being he needs interaction with other members of human society without which learning capacity is lost. This process of transformation is called socialization.

In this process, as defined by the local culture, they learn what roles are associated with their status and at the same time they learn how to play these roles.

Unlike other living species, whose behavior is mostly or entirely set by biology, human beings need social experience to learn their culture for the survival.

It can be said that we learn the following through the socialization process:

- **Knowledge**
- **Social and technical Skills**
- **Culture**

- **Discipline**
- **Manners**
- **Behavioral pattern**
- **Importance and techniques to develop relationship**
- **Rules and regulations**
- **Code of conduct**
- **Religion**
- **Different roles and ways to perform roles**

Social experience is also the foundation of personality: *a person's fairly consistent patterns of acting, thinking, and feeling*. We build a personality by internalizing—taking in our surroundings. But without social experience personality hardly develops at all.

There are two school of thoughts in the sociology: first one are the bio-determinist who consider that inborn factors (nature) greatly influence the human behavior and personality. On the other hand socio-cultural determinists are of the view that environment and culture (nurture) have the great impact on the human and personality. Both the concepts have described as under.

- **Nature** It implies the contribution of heredity to the human being, which may include physical-characteristics and what is inside the human body. Presumably physical and psychological characteristics can be transmitted through heredity. Whatever is being transmitted through heredity may be considered as human Potential given by nature.
- **Nurture:** The word nurture is derived from the Latin verb *nutrire*, meaning "to suckle" or "to nourish." Originally, the verb *nurture* meant "to feed or nourish." In socialization process it is assumed that much of the human behavior is not instinctive; rather it is learned. Thus, people everywhere are equally human, differing only in their learned cultural patterns, which highlighted the role of nurture.
- Sociologists use the term socialization to refer to *the lifelong social experience by which people develop their human potential and learn culture*.

Formal Socialization:

Formal Socialization refers to the learning of societal norms, values, culture, skills and knowledge etc. in a formal environment to get fit into society. In formal socialization human

behavior is controlled and governed through rules, regulations, authority, code of conduct and restrictions. Family, workplace, school, state and religion are the formal agents of socialization.

Informal Socialization:

It refers to learning of social and technical skills, norms, values, knowledge and culture outside formal structure. Socialization through peer group and mass media is kept in this category. It is less effective in maintaining social order.

Importance/ Functions of Socialization

The process of socialization has significant importance in our life. The following description makes it very clear.

1. Converts the Biological Being into the Social Being

Man is not born social; He becomes social by virtue of the process of socialization. Various instances have made it very clear that only through constant training process the newborn child becomes social in nature.

2. Development of Personality

Personality is a product of society. In the absence of groups or society, no one can develop a personality of his own, rather it is a process through which the personality of the new born child is shaped and molded. Through this process the child learns an approved way of social life and develop his individuality.

3. Helps to be disciplined

Socialization is essentially the learning of rules and behavioral patterns. It is the mean of learning values, norms, aims and objectives of life. It disciplines an individual and helps him to live according to the social expectations.

4. Helps to Enact Different Roles

Every individual has to enact different roles in his life. Every role is woven around norms and is associated with different statuses. The process of socialization assists an individual not only to learn the norms associated with roles but also to develop appropriate attitudes to enact those roles properly.

5. Attainment of Technical and Social Skills.

Socialization is a way of training the newborn individual in certain technical and social skills, which are required to lead a normal social life. These skills help the individual to play economic, relational, professional, educational, religious and political roles in his latter life. In primitive societies for, example, imparting skills to the younger generation in specific occupations was an important aspect of socialization and in the modern there are different educational and vocational training institutes that impart such skills among youth to lead a prosperous life.

6. Helps to Develop Right Aspirations

Every individual may have his own aspirations; ambitions and desires in life. All these aspirations may not always be in consonance with the social interests. Some of them even be opposed to the communal interests. But through the process of socialization an individual learns to develop those aspirations which are complementary to the interests of society. Socialization helps him to direct or channelize his whole energy for the achievement of such aspirations.

7. Contributes towards the Stability of Social Order

It is through the process of socialization that every new generation is trained acceding to the Cultural goals, ideals, and social norms of a society which helps to normalize individual's behavior. At the same time it ensures social order by guiding individuals to follow norms and laws. Moreover it assures the cultural continuity of the society. Every new generation does need not start its social life in a new way fresh rather they can conveniently rely on the earlier generations to follow cultural values. In this regard, socialization contributes to the stability of the social order.

8. Helps to Reduce Social Disparities

Socialization reduces social distance and brings people together if proper attention is given to it. Through provision of proper training and guidance to the children during their early years, it is possible to reduce the social disparities and differences among people of various castes, races, regions, religions and professions.

9. Provides Scope for Bright Destiny of Mankind

Socialization is one of the powerful instruments of changing the destiny of mankind. It is through the process of socialization that a society can produce a generation who understand cultural differences and tolerate these differences for the prosperous and peaceful future of mankind. This process can significantly reduce conflicts among nations as well which will lead towards harmony. Such improvement will definitely offer one of the greatest possibilities for the future alteration of human relation and nature of society.

Types of Socialization

1. Primary Socialization

It is that Type of socialization that occurs during childhood inside the home, (Family). During first intimate association with family child's personality development process is established. Here a child learns language, identification of relations, habit training, gender roles' and other cultural practices.

2. Secondary Socialization

It is that part of socialization which starts after childhood and continues throughout life. Secondary socialization process helps individuals to learn the following:

- Learns an appropriate behavior of other groups within on society
- Develops understanding about potentials
- Skill development
- Other's culture
- Tolerance
- Discipline
- Responsibility
- Co-operation
- authority
- Fashion sense
- Expands relationship web
- Perform different roles perfectly

3. Developmental Socialization

It is types of socialization that involves developing, or enhancing one's social and technical skills. These skills are learnt to enhance efficiency to perform different economic, social and relational roles and responsibilities in an appropriate way.

4. Anticipatory Socialization

It is a Process of learning a specific group culture conduct or behavior pattern with an intention to join that particular group. Examples may include actors, soldiers, lawyers, bureaucrat, journalists, and doctors.

5. Re-Socialization

It is a rehabilitation or settlement process which may be explained as discarding former or previous behavioral patterns and learn/accept new ones such as rehabilitation of criminals and immigrants settlement.

AGENTS/Sources/Agencies of Socialization

Socialization agents are the sources from which we learn about society and ourselves. People and groups that influence our self-concept, emotions, attitudes, and behavior are called agents of socialization. Groups and people who serve as socializing agents include family members, friends, neighbors, the police, the employers, teachers, political leaders, business leaders, religious leaders, sports stars, and entertainers. Socialization agents also can be fictional characters that we read about or see on television or in the movies.

Every social experience we have affects us in at least a small way. Some of the important agents of socialization are as below.

1. The Family:

The parents or family are the first to socialize the child. From the parents he learns language and its dialect. He is taught societal morality and a number of civic virtues. The family is rightly called the cradle of social virtues. The child gets his first lessons of cooperation, tolerance, self-sacrifice, love and affection in the family. The environment of a family influences the growth of a child. The psychologists have shown that a person is what he becomes in a family. In a bad family the child learns bad habits whereas in a good family he acquires good habits. If in a family abusive language is used or a child is physically tortured, it will have a negative impact on him, he will be shy, less creative and narrow minded. On the other hand if a child is grown up

in a family where he receives love, affection, and encouragement, he will definitely possess positive traits such as kindness, confidence and he will be broadminded, and creative as well. The family continues to exercise its influence throughout life.

2. The School:

The school is the secondary and formal agent of socialization. In the school the child gets his education which molds his ideas and attitudes. Here he learns punctuality, regularity, cooperation, competition and different linguistic skills. School is also a source of developing intellectual ability of a child through testing his potentialities. A good education system can make the child a good citizen, while a bad education can turn him into a criminal. Education is of great importance in socialization. Only a well-planned system of education can produce socialized, well-mannered and productive citizens.

3. The Peer group

It is a group of playmates and friends with same age, interests and similar socio-economic status. It is an informal and secondary agent of socialization. The relation between the child and his playmates is one of equality. It is based on cooperation and mutual understanding. Sometime a child acquires such social skills from his friends and playmates which he cannot acquire from parents.

From them he acquires cooperative morality and some of the informal aspects of culture like fashions, fads, crazes, modes of gratification and forbidden knowledge too. The knowledge of such things is necessary from the social point of view. If a friend circle obtain positive traits and are competent then it will have appositive impact on the psyche of a person otherwise it will affect their psyche badly.

4. The Mass Media

The mass media is a secondary and informal agent of socialization. It have enormous effects on our attitudes and behavior, and on shaping people's opinions about issues. Achievements, information about inventions and technological advancement is shared on media which may be a source of inspiration for many people. Through mass media individuals learn about fashion sense, trending and knowledge about material and non-material aspects of culture.

5. The Religion

Religion has been an important factor in society. In the early society religion provided a bond of unity. Though in modern society the importance of religion has diminished, yet it continues to mold our beliefs and ways of life. In every family some or the other religious practices are observed on one or the other occasion. The child sees his parents going to the masjid or temple or any other religious place to performing religious acts and ceremonies. For example participation in religious ceremonies not only teaches us beliefs about the hereafter but also ideas about dress, concepts of *pak* and *pleet*, and manners appropriate for formal occasions. He listens to religious sermons which may determine his course of life and shape his ideas. It influences morality, becoming a key component in people's ideas of right and wrong. The influence of religion extends to many areas of our lives.

6. The State

The state is an authoritarian formal and secondary agent of socialization. It makes laws for the people and lays down the modes of conduct expected of them. The people have compulsorily to obey these laws. If they fail to adjust their behavior in accordance with the laws of the state, they may be punished for such failure. Thus the state also molds our behavior and citizens learn a lot of moral, legal and ethical code of conduct.

7. The Work Place

It is a place where one performs different economic activities, or indulges in monetary matters. Workplace a secondary and formal agent of socialization. Here individuals learn formal ways of requesting, behaving, communication skills, dress codes, punctuality and authority. In the workplace persons are provided with the opportunity to implement his potentials and skills which he have learned during early socialization.

Socialization through the Life Course

Life course is a biological process. In this process there is a personal change from infancy through old age and death brought about as a result of the interaction between biographical events and social events. The series of major events, the stages of our lives from birth to death,

may be called **life course**. As such life course is biological process, which has been divided into four distinct stages:

- **Childhood**
- **Adolescence**
- **Adulthood**
- **Old age**

Each life course stage by age is also affected by other factors like social class, gender, ethnicity and human experience. People's life experiences also vary depending on when, in the history of society, they were born. Some specific historical events like the creation of Pakistan, terrorist attacks of 9/11, economic Prosperity/ depression, war, or some other natural calamity (an earthquake, epidemic, and flood) may become significant in the personal development of individuals as well as their attitudes toward life and other people. Although childhood has special importance in the socialization process, learning continues throughout our lives.

Childhood

Childhood usually covers the first 12 years of life: time for learning and carefree play. Nevertheless, what a child "is" differs from one culture to another. Presently we defend our idea of childhood because children are biologically immature. But a look back in time and around the world shows that the concept of childhood is rooted in culture. Even in the developed countries, say a couple of centuries back, children of four or five years were treated like adults and expected to earn for themselves. A century back, children in USA, Canada, and Europe had much the same life as children in poor countries. That is how we come across the issue of child labor, which is associated with the developing countries.

Children in lower class have always assumed adult responsibilities sooner than their other class Counter parts. Due to the demands of the circumstances children in the lower class start earning earlier than the children in other classes. Their childhood finishes too quickly and may be their childhood remains invisible. In childhood an individual is made to learn the skills needed in adult life.

Adolescence

Just as industrialization helped create childhood as a distinct stage of life, adolescence emerged as a buffer between childhood and adulthood. We generally link adolescence, or teenage years,

to emotional and social turmoil, when the youth try to develop their own individual identities. As they try to carve out an identity distinct from both the “younger” world being left behind and the “older” world still be out of their range, adolescents develop a subculture of their own. More often we attribute teenage turbulence to the biological changes of puberty. In these emotional and social spheres the young people appear to be in conflict with their parents. Establishing some independence and learning specialized skills for adult life. Adulthood again depends on culture, and accordingly there could be a smooth or difficult change from childhood to adolescence. The 18 years old may have different statuses and roles in Pakistani society. They have the voting rights, they can get an ID card, they can get a driving licence, and they work in offices.

Adulthood

Adulthood, which begins between the late teens and the early thirties, depending on the social background, is a time for accomplishment. They pursue careers and raise families. These youth embark on careers and raise families of their own. They reflect on their own achievements. The adulthood can be divided into two parts.

Early Adulthood: It covers the period from 20 to about 40 years, and during this period personalities are formed. They learn to manage the day-to-day responsibilities personally. They try to make an adjustment with spouse, and bring up their children in their own way. They often have many conflicting priorities: parents, partner, children, schooling, and work.

Middle Adulthood: Roughly covers the period from 40 to 60 yrs. During this period the individuals assess actual achievements in view of their earlier expectations.

Children are grown up and growing older start facing physical decline. During the late middle years (50 to 65 years), people attempt to evaluate the past and come to terms with what lies ahead. They compare what they have accomplished with how far they had hoped to get.

During this time of life, many people find themselves caring for their own children and also their aging parents. Health and mortality also begin to loom large. People feel physical changes in their bodies, and they may watch their parents become frail, ill and die.

Old Age

Old age – the later years of adulthood and the final stage of life itself – begins about the mid-sixties. The societies attach different meaning to this stage of life. Pakistani society often gives older people control over most of the land and other wealth. Since the rate of change in Pakistani society is not very fast, older people amass great wisdom during their lifetime, which earns them

much respect. On the other hand in industrial societies old are considered as conservative, unimportant, and obsolete. In a fast changing society their knowledge appears to be irrelevant. Growing up typically means entering new roles and assuming new responsibilities; growing old, by contrast, is the opposite experience – leaving roles that provided both satisfaction and social identity. Retirement from employment or even the handing over of the personal business to one's heirs, demands learning new, different patterns while at the same time unlearning familiar habits from the past.

It can be concluded that Societies organize the life course according to age; other forces, such as social class, ethnicity, and gender, also shape their lives. Thus the general pattern that has been described earlier, apply somewhat differently to various categories of people.

Theories of Socialization

When you were born, you had no ideas. You didn't know that you were a son or daughter. You didn't even know that you were a he or she. How did you develop a **self**, your image of who you are? And how did you develop your ability to reason? Let's find out.

Socialization is a complex, lifelong process. We shall focus on the works of pioneer researchers, namely Sigmund Freud (1856 -1939), George Herbert Mead (1863 -1931), and Charles Horton Cooley (1864 -1929).

1. George Herbet Mead: The Social Self

G.H Mead (1863-1931) developed a theory of social behaviorism to explain how social experience creates individual personality. There is the power of environment to shape behavior. Mead's central concept is self that part of an individual's personality composed of self-awareness and self-image. For Mead:

- I. The self develops only with social experience. The self is not part of body, and it does not exist at birth. Self develops only as the individual interacts with others. In the absence of interaction (as is evident from the cases of isolated children like Anna, Isabelle, Genie) the body grows, but no self emerges.

- II. Social experience is the exchange of symbols. Only people use words, or the wave of the hand, or a smile to create meaning. These symbols are parts of the language, which plays a vital part in the development of self. Self is a product of socialization experiences and that it develops along with our ability to think symbolically.
- III. Understanding intention requires imagining the situation from the other's point of view. Using symbols we imagine ourselves "in another person's shoes" and see ourselves as the person does. We can therefore anticipate how others will respond to us before we act. A simple toss of a ball requires stepping out of ourselves to imagine how others will catch our throw. You may call it as to think symbolically.

Thinking consists of the conversations we carry on in our minds with ourselves about all sorts of things, especially about ourselves. As a child, you eventually developed cognitively to the point at which you were able to use one symbol (a doll, for example) to represent a parent and another symbol (another doll, for example) that represent you. Only then you could engage in role taking- imagining being some one else and looking from that person's perspective back at yourself as a social object. That is the imitation of the role of others. Out of others. Out of the early social interaction we develop our ability to communicate, our ability to think, and our social self-emerge.

- IV. By taking the role of the other, we become self-aware. The self then has two parts. As subject, the self is active and spontaneous. Mead called the active side of the self as "I" (the spontaneous from of the personal pronoun). "I" is the self as subject the active, spontaneous, creative part of self. But the self is also an object, as we imagine ourselves as others use us. Mead called the objective side of the self the "me" (the objective from of personal pronoun). All social experience have both components.

The emergence of self consists of three stages:

1. The Play Stage

During the play stage, a child begins to develop a sense of him/herself as a social object by taking the role of significant others in relation to him/herself. A girl child plays at being her mother or father, which requires investing herself imaginatively into a doll, for example. She then makes the doll behave as she behaves and evaluates and reacts to this behavior of the

doll. She mimics the way in which her father or mother reacts to her own behavior. In this way, she begins to make sense of why the parents react to her as they do. At this stage, the child's self consists exclusively of the ideas she has about herself based on her perceptions of how significant others, one at a time, view that self. (Significant others are the persons who are very important for the individual)

2. The Game Stage

In the play stage, the child took the role of one significant other at a time. In order to play games, however, the child must be able to take the roles of other players in the game simultaneously. In a game (cricket, for example) each player must know what all the other players expect of him in any situation that might come up. Being able to evaluate oneself from the perspective of several significant others simultaneously results in more sophisticated self-concept.

3. The Stage of the Generalized Other

The generalized other represents the imagined perspective of the community or society at large. At this stage of development, the child is capable of evaluating himself from the perspective of community, sub-cultural, or culture norms and expectations. The child tries to shape his behavior in accordance with the expectations of the others and tries to become what others want him to become.

2. Charles H. Cooley: The looking Glass Self

Others represent a mirror (which people used to call a "looking glass") in which we can see ourselves. What we think of ourselves, then, depends on what we think others think of us. For example, if we think others see us as clever, we will think ourselves in the same way. But if we feel they think of us as clumsy, then that is how we will see ourselves. Cooley used the phrase looking glass self to mean a self-image based on how we think others see us.

Our sense of self develops from interaction with others. The term looking glass self was coined by Cooley to describe the process by which a sense of self develops. The looking glass self contains three elements:

- I. **We imagine how we appear to those around us.** For example, we may think that others us witty or dull.
- II. **We interpret other's reactions.** We come to conclusions about how others evaluate us. Do they like us being witty? Do they dislike us for being dull?
- III. **We develop a self-concept.** Based on our interpretations of the reactions of others, we develop feelings and ideas about ourselves. A favorable reflection in this “social mirror” leads to a positive self-concept, a negative reflection to a negative self-concept.

Note that the development of the self does not depend on accurate evaluations. Even if we grossly misinterpret how others think about us, those misjudgments become part of our self-concept. Note also that self-concept begins in childhood; its development is an ongoing, lifelong process.

The three steps of the looking glass self are a part of our everyday lives, and as we monitor how other people react to us, we continuously modify the self. The self, then is never a finished product, but is always in process, even into old age.

3. Freud's Model of Personality Development

Freud believed that biology plays a major part in human development, though not in terms of human instincts. He theorized that humans have two basic needs that are there at birth. First is the need for bonding, which Freud called the “life instinct”. Second, we have an aggressive drive he called the “death instinct”. These opposing forces operate at unconscious level and generate deep inner tension.

Freud joined basic needs with the influence of society to form a model of personality with three parts:

- i. **Id**
- ii. **Ego**
- iii. **Superego**

The id (the Latin word for it) represents the human being's basic drives, which are unconscious and demand immediate satisfaction. Rooted in biology id is present at birth, making a new born a bundle of demands for attention, touching, and food. But society opposes the self-centered id, which is why one of the first words a child learns is “no.”

THE ID (“It”): functions in the irrational and emotional part of the mind.

At birth a baby’s mind is all Id -want.

The Id is the primitive mind. It contains all the basic needs and feelings. It is the source for libido (psychic energy). And it has only one rule --> the “pleasure principle”: “I want it and I want it all now”. Id too strong i.e. bound up in self-gratification and uncaring to others.

Ego

To avoid frustration, a child must learn to approach the world realistically. This is done through ego (Latin word for I), which is a person’s conscious effort to balance innate pleasure-seeking drives with the demands of society.

Ego is the balancing force between the id and the demands of society that suppress it. The ego develops as we become aware of ourselves and at the same time realize that we cannot have everything we want. Ego too strong i.e. extremely rational and efficient, but cold, boring and distant

Super Ego

Finally, the human personality develops the superego (Latin meaning “above” or “beyond” the ego), which are the cultural values and norms internalized by an individual.

The superego represents culture within us i.e. the norms and values that we have internalized from our social groups.

The superego operates as our conscience, telling us why we cannot have everything we want. As a moral component of the personality, the superego gives us the feelings of guilt or shame when we break social rules or pride and self- satisfaction when we follow them. The superego begins to form as a child comes to understand that everyone’s behavior must take the cultural norms into account.

Superego too strong i.e. one feels guilty all the time, may even have an insufferably saintly personality.

To the id-centered child, the world is full of physical sanctions that being either pleasure or pain. As the superego develops, however, the child learns the moral concepts of right and wrong. Initially, in other words, the children can feel good or bad according to how they judge their behavior against cultural norms (doing “the right thing”).

The id and superego remain in conflict, but in a well-adjusted person, the ego manages these two opposing forces. Culture, in the form of superego, serves to *repress* selfish demands, forcing people to look beyond themselves. When conflicts are not resolved during childhood, they may surface as personality disorders later on.

